

users to synthesise complex ideas and streamline project management. Meanwhile, Google's AI-powered tools are making their way into education, offering personalised learning experiences for students and teachers alike.

Microsoft's Sales Agents – Driving revenue growth with AI

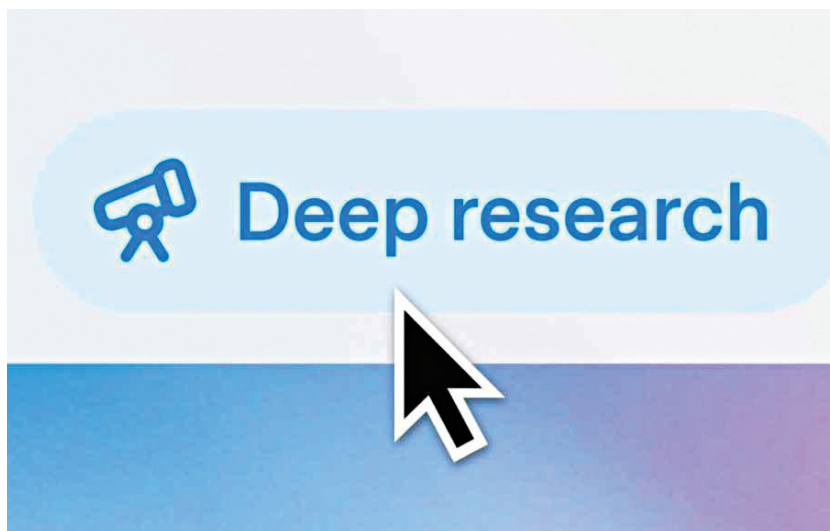
Microsoft has taken AI agents into the sales domain with its latest additions to Microsoft 365 Copilot. The Sales Agent and Sales Chat are designed to help sales teams close deals more efficiently by automating lead generation, scheduling meetings, and analysing CRM data.

These AI agents integrate directly with Microsoft Dynamics 365 and Salesforce, enabling seamless business operations.

With the ability to retrieve actionable insights from emails, meetings, and customer interactions, they provide real-time assistance that reduces manual workload and improves sales performance.

AI-powered developer assistance by Anthropic

Anthropic's Claude Code is an AI agent focused on software development. It integrates with development environments, assisting programmers by editing files, debugging code, resolving merge conflicts, and optimising workflows.



By embedding AI directly into the coding process, Claude Code streamlines development and reduces the time spent on troubleshooting. The AI agent operates within a terminal interface and can execute tasks such as running tests, reviewing pull requests, and generating documentation, making it an invaluable tool for software engineers.

OpenAI's elite research agent

OpenAI is pushing the boundaries of AI-driven research with its specialised AI agents designed for high-income professionals. The company's forthcoming AI lineup includes an agent for researchers priced at \$20,000 per month, which is tailored for PhD-level work. These advanced

AI models are intended to handle in-depth data analysis, scientific research, and strategic decision-making at an unprecedented scale.

While the pricing of these elite AI agents raises questions about accessibility, they highlight the growing demand for AI-driven expertise in academia and business intelligence. Companies investing in these high-end solutions aim to leverage AI's potential to maximise productivity and innovation.

Opportunities and challenges that lie ahead for AI agents

As AI agents continue to evolve, their applications will expand into more industries, from healthcare and finance to customer support and education. However, concerns regarding ethical AI use, job displacement, and accessibility remain. The high cost of premium AI agents, such as OpenAI's research assistant, underscores the need for more democratised access to AI-powered tools. Additionally, issues such as AI hallucinations – where models generate inaccurate or misleading information – must be addressed to ensure reliability. Developers and organisations must implement robust fact-checking mechanisms to mitigate risks associated with AI-generated content. **d**

